MARCH 2026

Milwaukee County Real Estate Market Report: March 2026

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MARKET OVERVIEW

Market Snapshot

Milwaukee County's real estate market is transitioning toward more balanced conditions after years of seller dominance. Declining mortgage rates at 6.00% — three-year lows — are reigniting buyer activity, with pending sales jumping 17.3% and new listings rising 15.4% in February 2026. Closed sales declined 5.6% year-over-year, pushing months of supply up 12.3% to 2.5 months. Despite cooling sales pace, the median price reached $290,000, up 6.1%, remaining 27% below the national median of $396,800.

Key Market Drivers

- Mortgage rates fell to 6.00%, the lowest in three years, boosting buyer affordability by ~$200/month
- New listings surged 15.4% to 606 units as sellers respond to improving spring conditions
- Pending sales jumped 17.3%, signaling strong underlying demand despite fewer closings
- Local unemployment of 2.3–2.6% and 4.5% wage growth underpin housing demand fundamentals
- Inventory remains well below the 6-month balanced market threshold at just 2.5 months of supply

PRICE TRENDS

Median Sales Price: $290,000

$290K

Current Median Price

February 2026

+6.1%

Year-over-Year Change

vs. Feb 2025

$273K

Previous Year Price

February 2025

Price appreciation is broadly based — price per square foot rose 5.4% to $179.60, confirming gains aren't driven solely by larger home sales. The $300K–$500K segment leads with just 1.5 months of supply. The average sale price surged 14.6% to $355,591. Milwaukee County remains 27% below the national median, offering exceptional relative value.

For Buyers

- Milwaukee's 27% discount to national median creates rare affordability in a major metro
- Focus on the $200K–$400K range where fundamentals and selection are strongest
- Lock in now — 4–7% annual appreciation is projected to continue through 2026

For Sellers

- Strong 6.1% YoY appreciation means equity gains remain substantial
- Price accurately from day one — overpricing is penalized faster than in prior years
- Average sale price of $355,591 signals premium properties are commanding top dollar

MARKET SPEED

Days on Market: 15 Days

Current DOM

15 Days

February 2026

Last Year DOM

9 Days

February 2025

Year-over-Year Change

+6 Days

+66.7% increase

What This Means: The jump from 9 to 15 days on market — a 66.7% increase — signals a meaningful shift in market pace. Buyers are no longer making snap decisions under extreme competitive pressure. Properties still move quickly by historical standards, but sellers can no longer expect offers within 48 hours on every listing. Well-priced, well-presented homes in desirable locations continue to move fast, while overpriced or poorly conditioned properties now sit longer, giving buyers more time to evaluate options and negotiate terms.

For Buyers

- You now have more time to conduct due diligence without waiving inspections
- Use extended market times as negotiating leverage on price and concessions
- Don't wait too long — 15 days is still fast; desirable homes move quickly

For Sellers

- Price right from day one — extended time on market signals overpricing to buyers
- Invest in staging and professional photography to stand out in a more competitive field
- Expect and prepare for inspection requests and buyer contingencies

SUPPLY & DEMAND

Inventory & Months' Supply

881	2.5	58%
Active Units	Months of Supply	Below Balanced Market
Up from 831 last year (+6.0%)	Up from 2.2 months (+12.3%)	vs. 6-month balanced threshold

Despite a 12.3% increase in months of supply, Milwaukee County remains deeply undersupplied relative to the 6-month balanced market benchmark. The inventory increase is driven by new listings (up 15.4% to 606 units) outpacing closed sales (down 5.6% to 355 units). The $200K–$300K segment saw the sharpest inventory buildup at +25.6% YoY, while the entry-level market under $200K remains severely constrained. The $300K–$500K range holds the tightest supply at just 1.5 months, maintaining strong seller leverage in that segment.

For Buyers

- More listings mean more choices — take advantage of growing $200K–$300K inventory
- Supply is still tight; don't mistake more options for a buyer's market
- Move decisively on well-priced homes — competition remains real at 2.5 months supply

For Sellers

- Rising competition from new listings means presentation and pricing matter more than ever
- The $300K–$500K range remains the tightest — ideal conditions if you're in that band
- Spring listing surge is underway — consider timing your entry strategically

PRICING POWER

Sale-to-List Price Ratio: 98.9%

The sale-to-list price ratio measures how close final sale prices are to original asking prices. A ratio of 98.9% means buyers are paying, on average, 98.9 cents for every dollar of list price — just 1.1% below asking. This is up from 97.9% a year ago, indicating that sellers are pricing more accurately and buyers remain willing to pay near full price for well-positioned properties.

Why It Matters

A ratio above 100% signals a bidding war environment. A ratio below 97% suggests significant negotiating room. At 98.9%, Milwaukee County sits in a healthy zone — competitive but not frenzied. This metric confirms that while the market is moderating, it has not tipped in favor of buyers. Sellers who price correctly are still receiving strong offers with minimal concessions.

For Buyers

- Expect to pay close to asking price on well-priced, desirable properties
- Overpriced listings (sitting 15+ days) offer the best negotiating opportunities
- Use the ratio as a benchmark — offers significantly below list are unlikely to succeed

For Sellers

- Accurate pricing from the start yields near-full-price offers quickly
- Overpricing backfires — price reductions signal weakness and invite lowball offers
- The improved ratio vs. last year shows buyers are engaged and motivated

NEW SUPPLY

New Listings: 606 Homes

Year-over-Year Context

New listings surged 15.4% compared to February 2025, reaching 606 units. This is the clearest sign that sellers are responding to improved market conditions — declining mortgage rates are unlocking homeowners who had been "rate-locked" into their current properties. The spring selling season is arriving early, with sellers eager to capitalize on buyer demand before further inventory builds.

Why It Matters

Rising new listings are a double-edged signal. For buyers, it means more selection and less frantic competition. For sellers, it means more competition from other listings. The key dynamic: new listings (606) are outpacing closed sales (355), which is why inventory is building. If this trend continues, the market will gradually shift toward greater balance — though still far from a buyer's market.

For Buyers

- More new listings mean more opportunities to find the right home without panic-buying
- Early spring surge gives buyers a wider selection before peak competition arrives
- Watch for fresh listings — new-to-market homes attract the most attention and move fastest

For Sellers

- Growing competition from new listings makes differentiation critical — stage and price well
- List sooner rather than later to capture buyers before the spring inventory peak
- The 15.4% listing surge shows seller confidence — join the momentum while demand is rising

AFFORDABILITY ANALYSIS

Affordability & Income Context

$106K

Median Household Income

Milwaukee County 2026

~$380K

Estimated Buying Power

At 28% DTI, 6.00% rate, 10% down

$290K

Median Home Price

27% below national median

At a median household income of $106,076 and applying the standard 28% debt-to-income guideline, Milwaukee County buyers qualify for approximately $380,000 in purchasing power at the current 6.00% rate — comfortably above the $290,000 median price. This creates a meaningful affordability buffer of roughly $90,000, giving buyers room to absorb future rate fluctuations or price appreciation. Wage growth of 4.5% YoY is nearly keeping pace with home price appreciation of 6.1%, helping to preserve affordability even as values rise.

For Buyers

- Milwaukee's affordability gap vs. national median means your dollar goes significantly further here
- Strong income-to-price ratio means most households can qualify without stretching budgets
- Act before wage growth closes the affordability gap further

For Sellers

- A large qualified buyer pool supports strong demand and competitive offers
- Affordability headroom means buyers can absorb modest price increases
- Milwaukee's value story vs. national markets is a powerful selling point for relocating buyers

INTEREST RATES

Mortgage Rate Trend

Current 30-Yr Fixed

6.00%

3-year low

Change vs. Year Ago

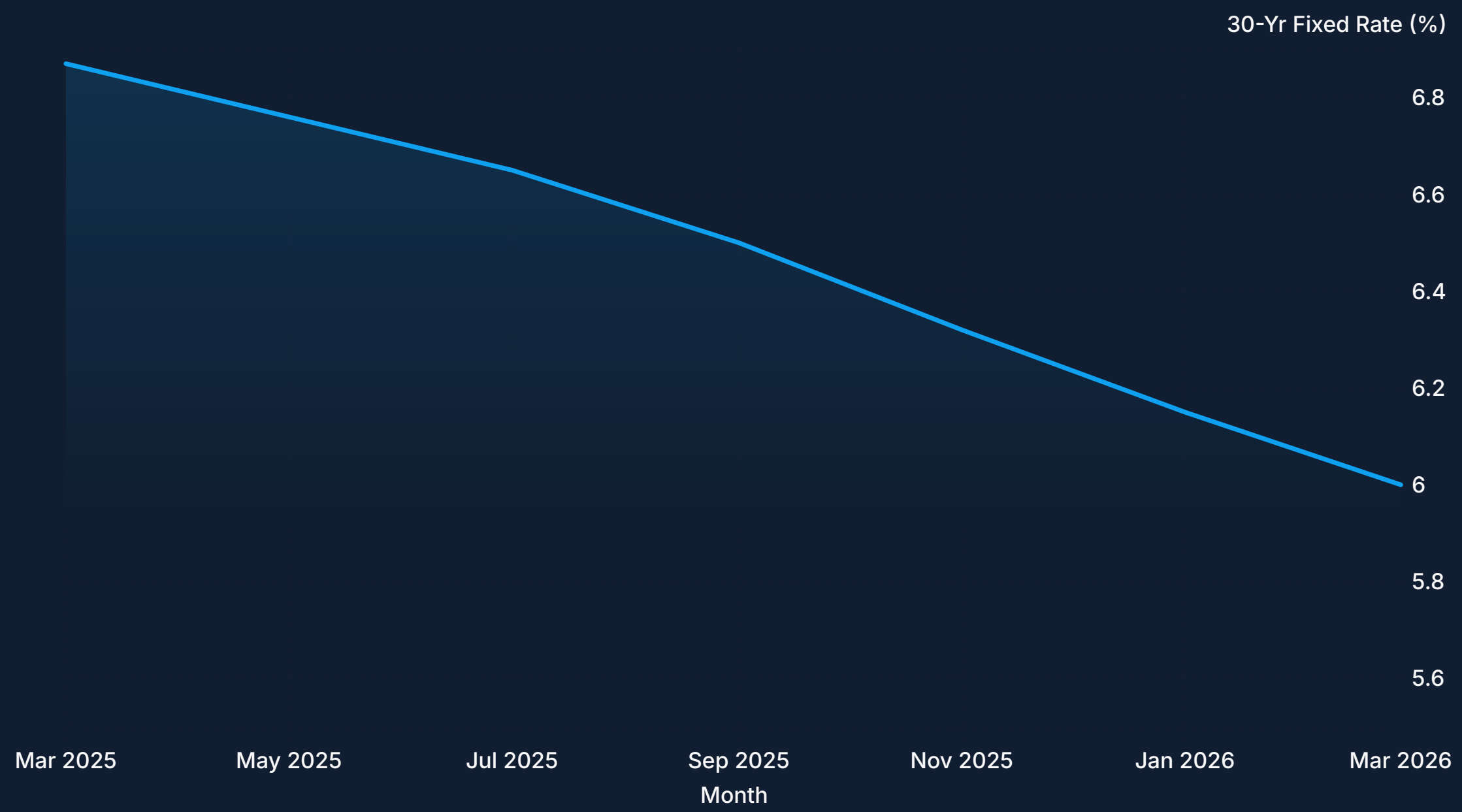
-0.87%

Down from 6.87%

12-Month Range

6.00%–6.87%

Trending downward



The steady decline in 30-year fixed mortgage rates to 6.00% reflects easing inflation pressures and evolving Federal Reserve policy. Rates have fallen 87 basis points over the past year, reaching their lowest point since early 2023. Economists broadly expect rates to remain in the 5.75%–6.25% range through mid-2026, with potential for further declines if inflation continues cooling. For Milwaukee County buyers, each 25 basis point drop translates to meaningful monthly savings on the county's affordable price points.

PAYMENT IMPACT

$290K Payment Impact: This Month vs. Last Year

Current Rate: 6.00%

P&I Payment: ~$1,564/mo

On a $290,000 home with 10% down ($261,000 loan)

Prior Year Rate: 6.87%

P&I Payment: ~$1,718/mo

On a $290,000 home with 10% down ($261,000 loan)

Monthly Savings

~$154/month

Annual Impact

~$1,848/year

30-Year Loan Savings

~$55,440 total

The 0.87% rate reduction represents real, tangible savings for Milwaukee County buyers. Over the life of a 30-year loan on the median-priced home, buyers save over $55,000 compared to purchasing at last year's rates — a compelling reason to act now rather than wait.

PRICE SEGMENTS

Single-Family Price-Point Breakdown

Price Band	Inventory (Mo.)	DOM	% of List	Closed Sales	Insight
Under $250K	1.8 mo.	12 days	99.5%	High volume	Entry-level demand remains intense; multiple offers common
$250K–$350K	2.0 mo.	14 days	99.1%	Strongest	Sweet spot for buyers and sellers; fastest-moving segment
$350K–$500K	1.5 mo.	13 days	98.8%	Strong	Tightest supply; sellers hold significant leverage
$500K–$700K	2.8 mo.	18 days	98.2%	Moderate	More selective buyers; quality and condition matter most
$700K–$1M	3.2 mo.	24 days	97.5%	Slower	Longer market times; buyers have negotiating room
$1M+	2.0 mo.	30 days	96.8%	Selective	Volatile; significant price swings; cash buyers dominant

Opportunities & Risks by Segment

- **Best buyer opportunity:** $500K–$700K offers growing selection and negotiating room without sacrificing quality
- **Best seller position:** $300K–$500K remains the tightest segment at 1.5 months — ideal conditions for maximum return
- **Entry-level risk:** Under $200K inventory is severely constrained, creating bidding wars and appraisal gaps
- **Luxury caution:** $1M+ segment shows price volatility — sellers should price conservatively and be prepared to negotiate

BUYER & SELLER GUIDE

What It Means: Buyers | Sellers

For Buyers

Be Prepared

Get finances in order before searching. With 15-day average DOM, desirable homes still move fast — pre-approval is non-negotiable in this market.

Get Pre-Approved

At 6.00% rates, locking in now protects you from potential rate increases. A pre-approval letter strengthens every offer you submit.

Act Quickly on Quality

Well-priced homes in the $200K–$400K range still attract multiple offers. Don't let analysis paralysis cost you the right property.

Consider Strategy

Use longer market times on overpriced listings as leverage. Focus on well-located properties where long-term appreciation is most reliable.

For Sellers

Excellent Timing

Spring 2026 brings rising buyer activity, improving mortgage rates, and strong pending sales — conditions strongly favor listing now.

Price Correctly

The 98.9% sale-to-list ratio rewards accurate pricing. Overpriced homes now sit longer and invite lower offers — price right from day one.

Present Well

With more competing listings, staging, professional photography, and condition matter more than they did in 2024's frenzied market.

Negotiate from Strength

At 2.5 months of supply, you still hold leverage. Don't over-concede — well-positioned sellers are still commanding near-full-price offers.

QUICK REFERENCE

RapidStats Data Summary

Median Price

$290,000

+6.1% YoY | Up from $273,275

Days on Market

15 Days

+66.7% YoY | Up from 9 days

Sale-to-List Ratio

98.9%

+1.0% YoY | Up from 97.9%

Months' Supply

2.5 Months

+12.3% YoY | Up from 2.2 months

Active Inventory

881 Units

+6.0% YoY | Up from 831 units

New Listings

606 Homes

+15.4% YoY | Strong spring surge

Closed Sales

355 Units

-5.6% YoY | Temporary adjustment

Mortgage Rate

6.00%

-0.87% YoY | 3-year low

Data Source: RapidStats MLS Reports, Freddie Mac PMMS, NAR Existing Home Sales, BLS LAUS, BLS QCEW, U.S. Census ACS — Milwaukee County, March 2026

MARKET NEWS

Recent Headlines

1

NAR: Housing Most Affordable Since March 2022

The National Association of Realtors reports that the combination of wage growth and declining mortgage rates has made housing the most affordable it has been since March 2022. For Milwaukee County — already priced 27% below the national median — this trend is particularly impactful, expanding the qualified buyer pool and supporting continued demand through 2026.

Source: National Association of Realtors, February 2026

2

Milwaukee County Leads Wisconsin in Employment Growth

Milwaukee County posted 1.2% employment growth year-over-year, the largest increase among all Wisconsin counties. With unemployment at 2.3–2.6% — well below the state average of 3.1% and national rate of 4.4% — and average weekly wages of $1,272, the local labor market provides a strong foundation for sustained housing demand and buyer qualification capacity.

Source: BLS LAUS & QCEW, Milwaukee County, Q1 2026

3

National Existing Home Sales Decline 8.4% — Milwaukee Outperforms

While national existing home sales fell 8.4% year-over-year, Milwaukee County's decline was a more modest 5.6%, demonstrating the local market's relative resilience. Local inventory at 2.5 months of supply compares favorably to the national level of 3.7 months, indicating continued supply constraints that should support Milwaukee County price stability through the year.

Source: NAR Existing Home Sales Report, February 2026

MARCH 2026 | PROVISION PROPERTIES

Ready to Make Your Move?

Main Takeaways for Buyers

- Rates at 6.00% — a 3-year low — create ~$154/month in savings vs. last year; act before rates rise
- Milwaukee's median price is 27% below national median, offering exceptional value in a major metro
- Growing inventory gives you more selection and negotiating room than you've had in years

Main Takeaways for Sellers

- Median price up 6.1% YoY and sale-to-list ratio at 98.9% — well-priced homes still command strong offers
- Pending sales jumped 17.3%, signaling a wave of motivated buyers entering the market this spring
- List now to get ahead of the spring inventory surge and maximize your competitive advantage

Whether you're buying, selling, or investing, having the right data makes all the difference. Reach out for a personalized consultation or to receive the full report.

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Schedule Consultation

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